

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

Data-Driven Insights for Engineering Leaders & HR
Strategists

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global Employment Status (65,437 respondents)

Full-time: 69% (dominant mode)

Independent contracting / freelancing: 16.4%

Full-time students: 13.2%

Other / not working: 16%

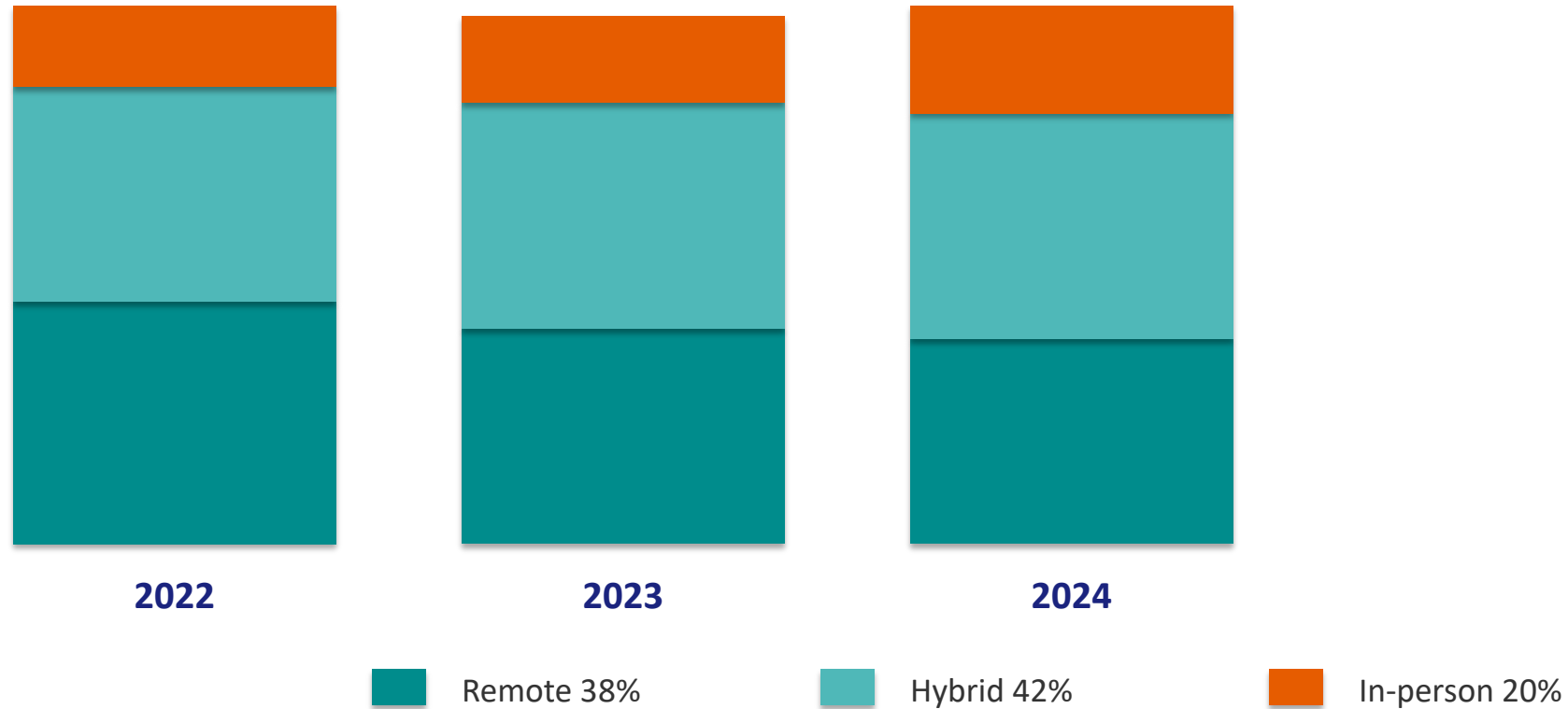
U.S. Full-Time Employment Shift

↓ **4.2 percentage points**

U.S. full-time employment dropped from 69% in 2023 to 64.8% in 2024

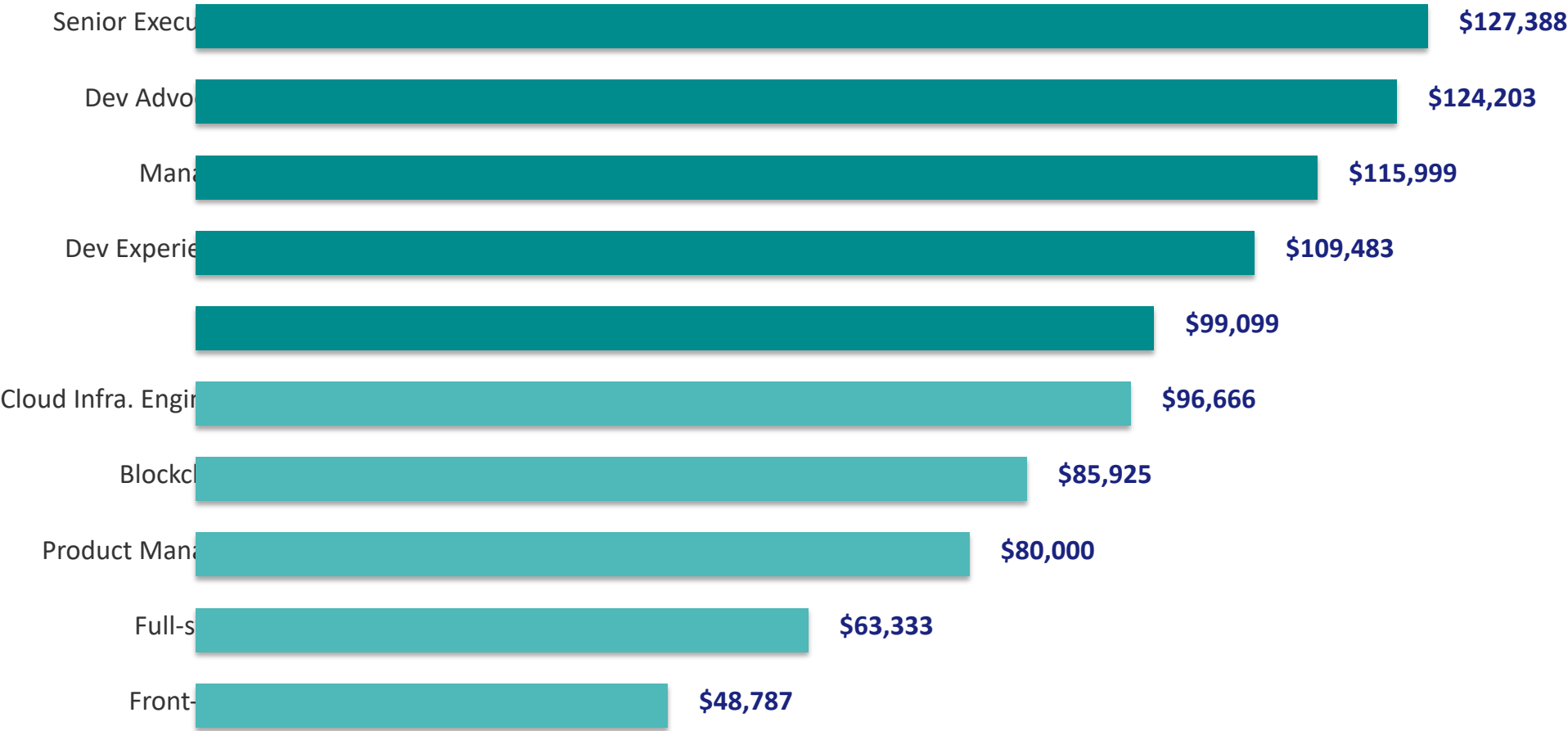
Note: In the U.K. and Ukraine, non-full-time respondents lean toward independent contracting; in Germany and India, they are more likely to be full-time students.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



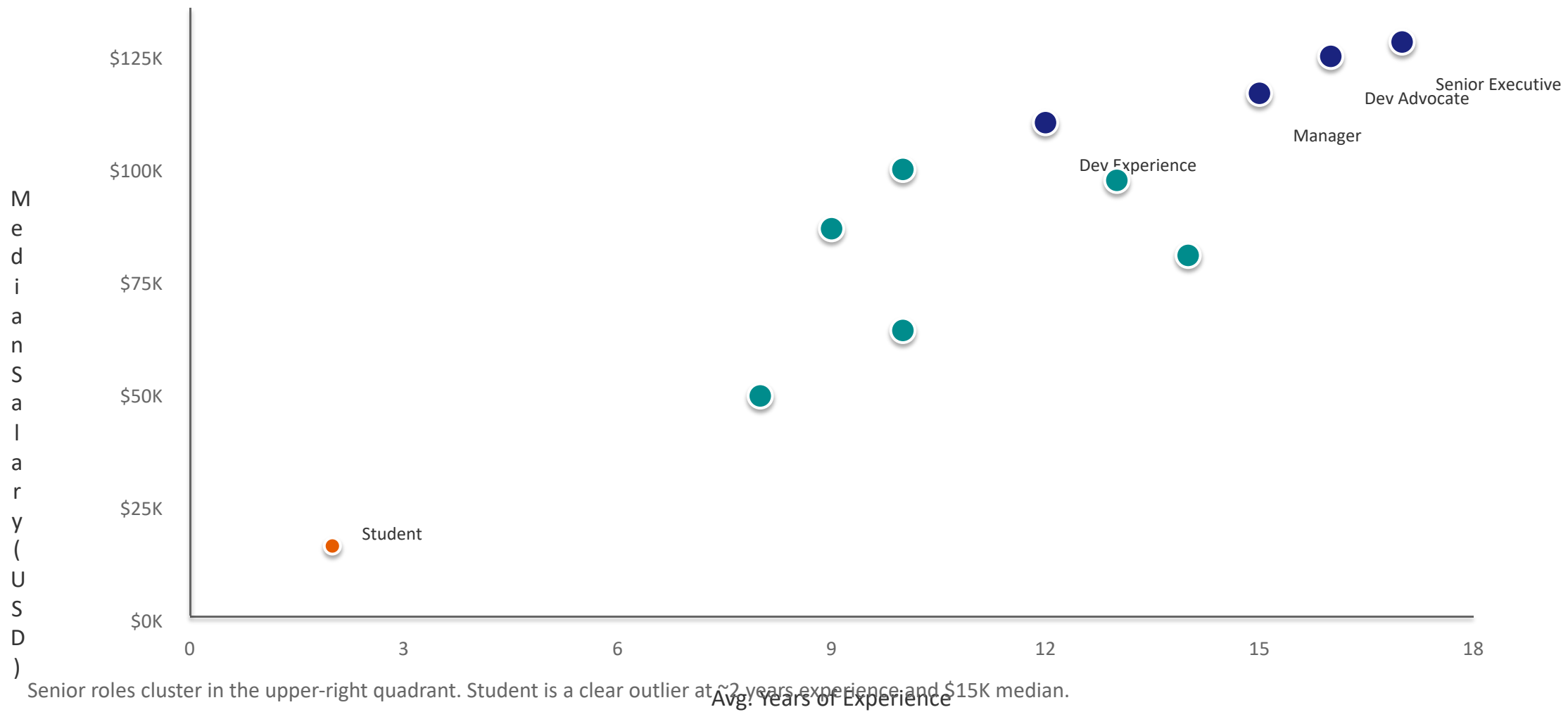
Insight: In-person work has risen for three consecutive years (15% → 16% → 20%), signaling a gradual return-to-office trend, though hybrid remains the most common arrangement.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

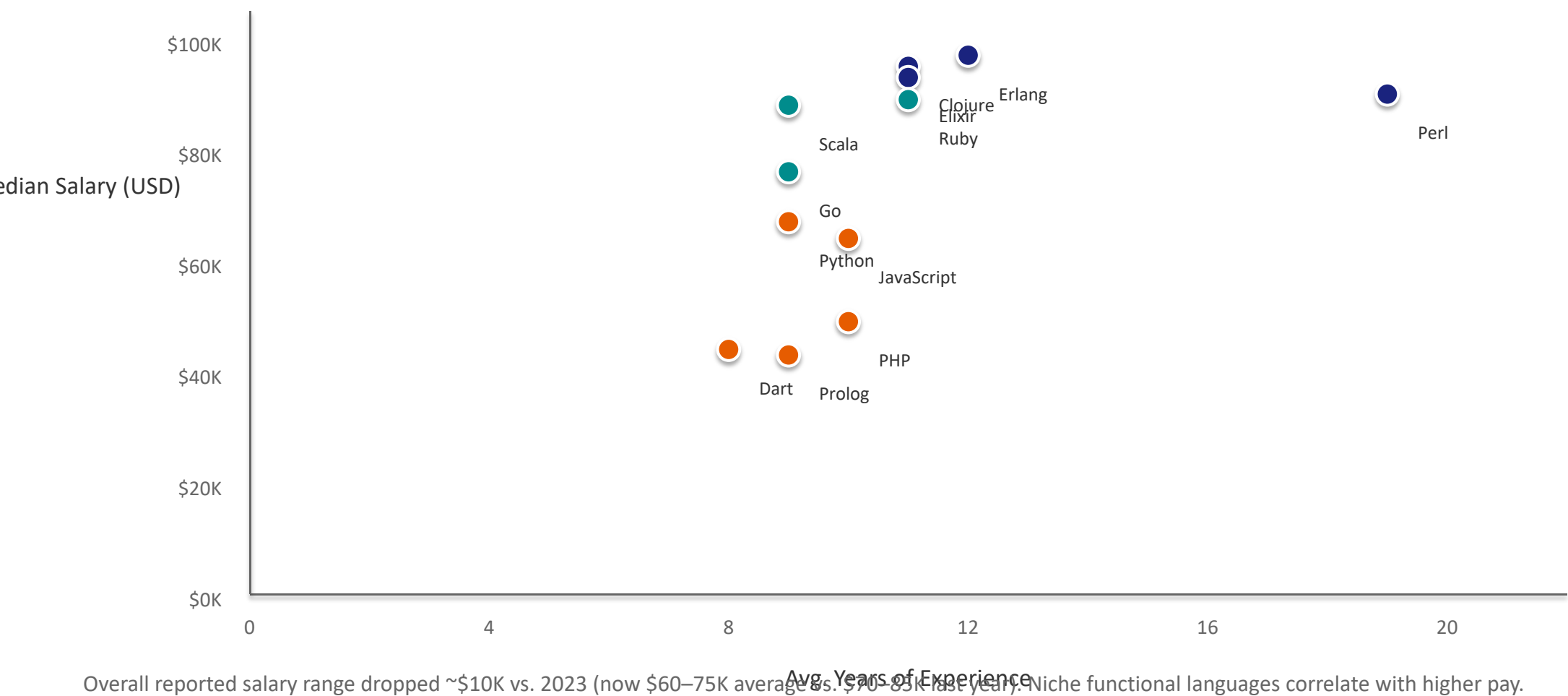


Source: 22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate). SRE and Cloud Infrastructure Engineers are the highest-paid purely technical roles.

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

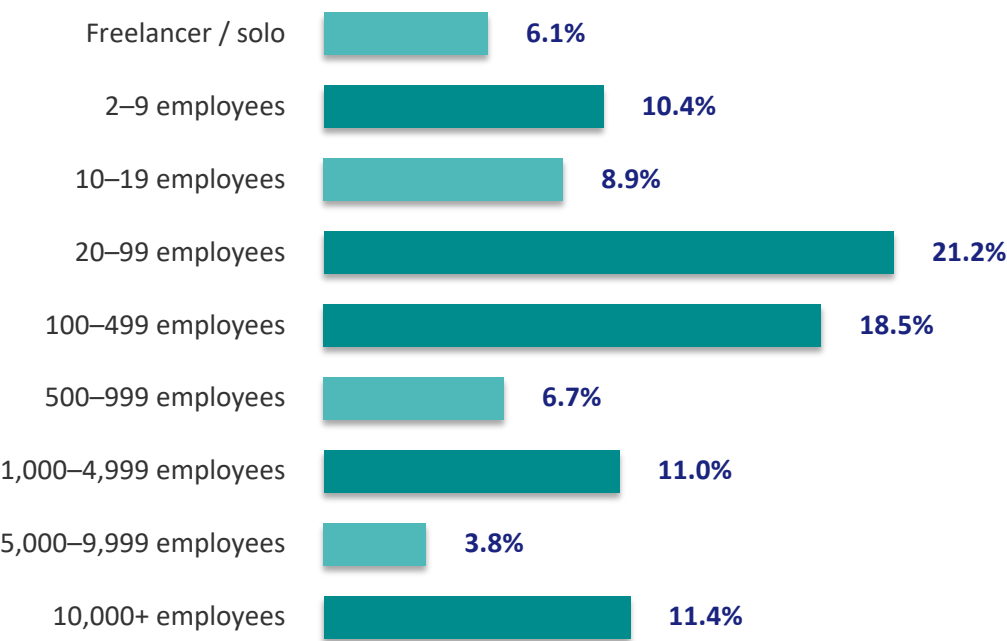


Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company Size Distribution (42,827 respondents)



Technology Purchasing Influence

62% of respondents influence technology purchases

Senior executives: 99%

Engineering managers: 87%

Product managers: 77%

60% prefer a build-and-buy approach

75% start with a free trial to evaluate tools

73% ask other developers for opinions

Vendor Strategy Insight

Target individual contributors, not just management — most developers have a say in tech buying decisions.

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1

Full-time employment is softening

U.S. full-time employment fell 4.2 pp YoY. Plan for more contractors and flexible arrangements in your workforce mix.

2

In-person mandates are growing, but hybrid still dominates

In-person work rose to 20% (from 15% in 2022). Retention strategies should accommodate hybrid preferences while preparing for RTO pressure.

3

DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay

Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and SREs (\$99K) top the charts. Budget competitively for these high-impact roles.

4

Language choice correlates with pay — niche languages pay more

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers earn >\$93K median. Mainstream languages like JavaScript and PHP sit well below \$65K.

5

Most developers influence purchasing — engage them directly

62% have a say in tech buying. Vendor strategies should target ICs with free trials and peer recommendations.